■ THE DAILY GOODS STORY SCOUT - Tuesday, October 27, 2026

TODAY'S RUNDOWN SLOTS

THE LIST (6 stories)

■■ *U.S. Justice Dept. charges James Comey, ex-FBI director, for a third time*

The Angle: *This is the latest round in the ongoing Trump-DOJ-vs-Comey saga, and the fact that prosecutors kept building this case in secret for weeks makes it feel like more than just political noise.*

- **James Comey**, the former **FBI Director**, has now been charged by the **Justice Department** for a **third time**.
- The case was assembled quietly and kept **under seal** for weeks before going public.
- **Comey** is **denying the allegations** outright and says he's gearing up to **fight the case**.

The Debate Starter

- Third charge against the same guy — accountability finally catching up, or does this start to look like a pattern?

torontosun.com (Tier 2) | Score: 82/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://torontosun.com/news/world/u-s-justice-dept-charges-james-comey-ex-fbi-director-for-a-third-time

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■ *NFL Week 7: A divisional duel in Detroit, and Aaron Rodgers keeps winning - NBC News*

The Angle: *NFL Week 7 had everything: a Super Bowl contender shaking off the rust, a nail-biter divisional grudge match, and Aaron Rodgers somehow still finding ways to win - exactly the kind of weekend that fuels Monday morning sports talk.*

- A legit **Super Bowl contender** got back on track after a rough patch
- **Detroit** hosted a thrilling **NFC North** divisional showdown
- **Aaron Rodgers** keeps winning, extending his surprising late-career streak
- One of the NFL's most unexpectedly good teams pulled off another comeback

The Debate Starter

- Is Aaron Rodgers quietly having his best 'written off too early' redemption run in years?

NBC News (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 81/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 24 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.nbcnews.com/sports/nfl/nfl-week-7-detroit-lions-green-bay-packers-aaron-rodgers-rcna605618

■ *Lawmaker urges South Korea's president to play Call of Duty: Modern Warfare 4, citing North Korea threat*

The Angle: *A sitting lawmaker is seriously suggesting the president game out a national security crisis via Modern Warfare 4 - it's the kind of real-politics-meets-absurd-pitch moment that writes its own punchline.*

- A **South Korean lawmaker** is publicly urging the **president** to play **Call of Duty: Modern Warfare 4**
- The pitch is tied directly to the ongoing **North Korea threat**
- Story is making rounds on **r/nottheonion** - the subreddit for real news too weird to believe

The Debate Starter

- Could gaming actually prep a leader for real crisis decisions, or is this just a lawmaker trying to go viral?

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://mbiz.heraldcorp.com/article/10912196

■ *Police Are Increasingly Pulling People Over Because AI Deems Their Driving Patterns “Suspicious”*

The Angle: *Police departments are leaning on AI systems to flag "suspicious" driving patterns and trigger traffic stops — which raises the classic sci-fi question of who's really making the call when you get pulled over, you or an algorithm.*

- Story centers on police **increasingly using AI** to analyze driving behavior
- The AI is reportedly flagging certain **driving patterns as "suspicious"** before an officer makes the call
- Those flags are said to be **triggering real traffic stops**, not just internal alerts

The Big Brother Debate

- Would you trust a computer to decide your driving looked "suspicious" enough to get pulled over?

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.aclu.org/news/privacy-technology/ai-driven-police-stops

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■ *In China, the AI bubble has already burst*

The Angle: *If the world's biggest AI spender is already watching the bubble pop, that's a huge red flag for every market - including ours - riding the same hype wave.*

The Debate Starter

- If China's AI bubble already burst, are we next - or are we different this time?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.reuters.com/world/china/china-ai-bubble-has-already-burst-2026-10-26/

■ *In Leaked Audio, Flock CEO Tells Cops Backlash to the Company Isn’t Real / In comments at a private police conference, Garrett Langley also said his wife advised him to never apologize.*

The Angle: *Flock's license-plate-reading cameras are now in thousands of police departments across the US and Canada, and privacy advocates have been sounding alarms for years — so leaked audio of the CEO privately telling cops the backlash is fake, plus his wife's 'never apologize' advice, is exactly the kind of corporate-arrogance tape that goes viral.*

- **Garrett Langley**, CEO of surveillance tech company **Flock**, was caught on leaked audio speaking at a **private police conference**
- He told the room the public backlash against his company **"isn't real"**
- He also shared that his wife's advice to him was to **never apologize**

The Debate Starter

- Would you trust a company whose own CEO privately brags that the backlash against it isn't real?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.404media.co/in-leaked-audio-flock-ceo-tells-cops-backlash-to-the-company-isnt-real/

Backup options:

■ *B.C. Conservatives celebrate winning election by burning down old growth forest*

The Angle: *A wild claim ripping through **r/canada** right now: that B.C. Conservative supporters celebrated an election win by setting fire to old growth forest — the kind of environmental-meets-political outrage that's built for a cross-border audience, verified or not.*

- The claim, circulating on **Reddit's r/canada**, says **B.C. Conservatives** marked their election win by burning down a stretch of **old growth forest**.
- No official confirmation yet from the party, police, or B.C. wildfire officials — this is currently a viral claim, not a confirmed incident.

The Outrage Trigger

- If this checks out, is torching old growth forest to celebrate a win the real scandal here — bigger than the election itself?

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.thebeaverton.com/2026/10/b-c-conservatives-celebrate-winning-election-by-burning-down-old-growth-forest/

■ *Neil Young Rocks Trump With $10M Suit Over Using That 'Free World' Tune Again*

The Angle: *Trump's campaign apparently cranked up 'Rockin' in the Free World' again, and Neil Young is done asking nicely — this time he's suing for $10 million, reigniting the classic rock-vs-politician fight.*

- **Neil Young** is suing **Donald Trump** for **$10 million** over unauthorized use of his song.
- The track in question: **'Rockin' in the Free World.'**
- Reports suggest this isn't the first time Young has clashed with Trump over using his music at events.

The Debate Starter

- Should politicians be allowed to use ANY song at rallies without asking the artist first?

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://deadline.com/2026/10/neil-young-sues-trump-copyright-1237205848/

■ *Donald Trump Posts 1,300+ Word Sunday Night Diatribe About "Complete And Total Loser" Bill Maher, Nine Days After Praising Their "Great Dinner"*

The Angle: *Nine days after publicly gushing over a dinner with Bill Maher, Trump dropped a 1,300+ word rant branding him a "complete and total loser" — a whiplash reversal that's catnip for anyone who follows Trump's social media mood swings.*

- Trump's post ran **over 1,300 words** — a full-blown essay, not a quick jab.
- He called **Bill Maher** a "**complete and total loser**" in the post.
- Just **nine days earlier**, Trump had praised their "**great dinner**" together.
- The timeline flip — warm dinner compliments to a lengthy takedown in under two weeks — is the whole story.

The Whiplash Factor

- Nine days from 'great dinner' to 'total loser' — what did Maher say to flip the switch that fast?

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://deadline.com/2026/10/trump-bill-maher-loser-truth-social-post-1237172835/

■ *Heckler at Trump's Mississippi rally: "Shove that ballroom up your fat ass!"*

The Angle: *A rally heckler went viral for cursing out Trump over his White House ballroom project, right as that renovation has already been a punching bag online for weeks. It's the kind of blunt, shareable soundbite that's made for a debate on who's actually in the right here.*

- A **heckler** interrupted **Trump's rally in Mississippi** with a profanity-laced shoutout.
- The exact line: **"Shove that ballroom up your fat ass!"** — a direct jab at his **White House ballroom** plans.
- Clip's been making rounds on **Reddit's r/fauxmoi**, racking up reactions for how blunt it is.

The Debate Starter

- Funny gut-punch or straight-up disrespectful — where do you land on heckling a sitting president?

Reddit r/fauxmoi (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://v.redd.it/nzyg3jlhexxh1

■ *N.S. woman refused to comply with phone scammer, so would-be fraudster swatted her house*

The Angle: *Phone scams turning into actual armed police response at your front door is the next-level nightmare version of a story everyone's already paranoid about — this one's got teeth because it could happen to literally anyone's parents.*

- A **Truro-area, Nova Scotia** woman says she's **"shaken and terrified"** after refusing to comply with a phone scammer.
- The scammer retaliated by **swatting** her house — faking an emergency to send police.
- **Heavily armed officers from two different departments** showed up at her home.
- The incident happened **over the weekend**.

The Phone-In Trigger

- Call in: what's the scariest scam call you've ever gotten, and did you hang up or play along?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/nova-scotia/swatting-incident-truro-area-fraud-scammer-9.7396654?cmp=rss

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■■ *Netanyahu's political survival on the line as Israel votes*

The Angle: *Israel heads to the polls with Netanyahu's career on the ballot — voters are judging his handling of October 7, the Gaza and Iran wars, and Israel's growing isolation on the world stage. It's a global story with real stakes for Middle East stability.*

- **Benjamin Netanyahu** faces a election on **Tuesday** that could decide whether his political career survives.
- Voters are weighing his leadership since the **2023 Hamas-led attacks**.
- The vote follows wars in **Gaza** and **Iran** under his watch.
- **Israel** is facing deepening **international isolation** heading into the election.

The Debate Starter

- Does a leader who took his country through war deserve another term, or is it time to turn the page?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/world/israel-election-9.7397565?cmp=rss

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CANADIAN NEWS (4 stories)

❤■ *At an Ontario grocery checkout, a mom staying in a shelter with her toddler discovered her gift cards for another store wouldn't work. Cashier Ada Everingham paid their $150 bill, and they've since secured a transitional townhouse where the little girl has her own bed.*

The Angle: *It's the kind of small, unscripted kindness that cuts through a heavy news day — a stranger stepping up for a mom at her lowest moment, with a genuinely happy update attached.*

- A mom staying in an **Ontario shelter** with her toddler hit the checkout and found her gift cards were for the wrong store
- Cashier **Ada Everingham** paid the **$150** bill out of her own pocket on the spot
- The family has since moved into a **transitional townhouse**
- The little girl now has her own bed for the first time

The Pay-It-Forward Moment

- Call in: what's the kindest thing a total stranger has ever done for you when you were struggling?

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.auroratoday.ca/local-news/a-miracle-mom-overwhelmed-by-kindness-of-cashier-who-paid-for-her-groceries-12930554

■■ *Asia Pays Top Dollar For Canadian Oil Amid Slump in US Prices*

The Angle: *While American oil prices are sliding, buyers in Asia are reportedly paying a premium for Canadian crude — a sign Canada may be leaning less on the US as its go-to energy customer, which matters big-time given the ongoing trade tension noise.*

- **Asian buyers** are reportedly paying **top dollar** for Canadian crude right now
- That premium is showing up at the same time **US oil prices** are slumping

- Signals Canada may have real leverage to sell elsewhere instead of depending on the US market

The Debate Starter

- If Asia wants to pay more for our oil than the US does, why are we still so dependent on American buyers?

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.bloomberg.com/news/articles/2026-10-26/asia-pays-top-dollar-for-canadian-oil-amid-slump-in-us-prices

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■ *Why a spate of gun-for-hire shootings in Toronto were likely paid for by Iran*

The Angle: *A string of targeted, gun-for-hire shootings in Toronto is reportedly being traced back to Iran — meaning a foreign government may be using local criminals as hired muscle on Canadian soil, which is a wild, unsettling wrinkle most people assume only happens in spy movies.*

- A **spate of shootings in Toronto** is being investigated as **gun-for-hire** hits, not random violence.
- Investigators reportedly believe the attacks were **likely paid for by Iran**.
- The pattern points to a **foreign state allegedly outsourcing violence** to criminals rather than acting directly.

The Debate Starter

- If a foreign government is quietly paying criminals to pull triggers in our own cities, how alarmed should Canadians actually be?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/investigates/iran-gun-for-hire-shootings-9.7396038?cmp=rss

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■■ *Olivia Chow races to victory as head of progressive new Toronto council*

The Angle: *Toronto's mayor heads into this term with a council that actually leans her way for once — a rare alignment that could decide how fast real change moves in Canada's biggest city.*

- **Olivia Chow** comes out of this race with a **more progressive council** backing her up, not fighting her.
- It's being called a win for the **left-leaning bloc** at **Toronto city hall**, beyond just the mayor's chair.
- The shift could mean less gridlock on **Chow's** big-ticket priorities going forward.

The Debate Starter

- Does a council that finally agrees with the mayor get more done, or just move faster in one direction?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/toronto/olivia-chow-progressive-council-toronto-mayor-second-term-9.7396703?cmp=rss

Backup options:

■■ *PQ accuses Ottawa of muzzling Quebec during upcoming Canada-EU summit*

The Angle: *A Canada-EU summit lands in Montreal and the feds won't let Quebec's own leader say a word on the mic - that's prime fuel for the usual Quebec-vs-Ottawa turf war.*

- **PQ leader Paul St-Pierre Plamondon** is accusing the federal government of muzzling Quebec
- The **Canada-EU summit** kicks off **Oct. 28** - and it's happening in **Montreal**
- Ottawa reportedly refused to let him speak at the summit despite it being on Quebec soil

The Debate Starter

- If a big international summit sets up shop in your backyard, should your province get a seat at the table - or does Ottawa call the shots, period?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/montreal/quebec-premier-speech-canada-eu-summit-montreal-9.7397619?cmp=rss

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■ *LIVE3 Digital Channel*

The Angle: *A new digital channel from a major Canadian broadcaster is worth a quick mention for anyone tracking how fast live TV is moving online - but there's barely any detail to go on yet.*

The Quick Hit

- Anyone even notice the shift to digital-first channels anymore, or is it background noise at this point?

CTV News (via Google News) (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://news.google.com/rss/articles/CBMidkFVX3lxTFBtZGkyVlFzWlRaVjJmS3RwSkg0Qm9yNGJPYklnQkcybE5XZ21Pczc0X3M4R3RwbDdRbm4zakd1ZkNPV3hPUnBSNlBRZUdaLXh1eXFoTkducDY2eVhtVEJhdXFNWUVNVWRCYVZqZE9kOVpMdzRSR0E?oc=5

■■ *Here is a look at results from mayoral elections across the GTHA*

The Angle: *Mayoral elections just wrapped up across the Greater Toronto and Hamilton Area, and the results shape everything from property taxes to transit for millions of listeners - this is the kind of 'did my city change hands' story that gets phones lighting up.*

The Local Buzz

- Call in - did your city keep its mayor or flip to someone new?

CTV News (via Google News) (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://news.google.com/rss/articles/CBMimwFBVV95cUxNZmM2NFd5SU5zeTlwRGpzOFF3dTEzZmMwU3l2MW1UMHJnb3IxRzcxX09rZFFyYU5vRkRIaXhuSFlTWUZNRzc2Ny1TSHhxMnFuZFBya3VzWW1VOFRTbkotc2JTbGF1N3pEbC1YcHJRdVlvV2ZQUGlKalhUNGFGLWc0WVZmcTVFZEZkR1Y2R3J6NVhmNjZ0b3pqRFdESQ?oc=5

■■ *James Moore: David Eby treated B.C. voters like fools, and paid the price*

The Angle: *A sharp opinion piece is accusing B.C. Premier David Eby of condescending to voters - and saying it's now biting him politically. Provincial leadership under fire always makes for good Canadian political chatter.*

- Columnist **James Moore** - a former federal Conservative cabinet minister - is the one leveling the critique.
- The target is **B.C. Premier David Eby**.
- The core claim: Eby treated B.C. voters "like fools" - and is now facing the political fallout.

The Debate Starter

- Do politicians who get called out for being condescending ever actually recover - or is that label impossible to shake?

CTV News (via Google News) (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://news.google.com/rss/articles/CBMirwFBVV95cUxQTERRU1RGM2plZ1NGQ29zWTRid3VhODJqS2E0ZXRJTzhsZW81RTVEYTFoakJ4LXRmclFFV09JajFjYl9PbzluS2loUmpTdVJMQWppTzcyTXFyNTdhQTl5ZHJmbGF0c3YxU29VTjlCZGRoV0ZERkNaYkJJcFRTdVZmZVY2aXhySUQyQ1J6Tk9XTzlGQXFVZGtuYWQ2c3BDV1o0cVRNOUlpWGE1ajgwdkxB?oc=5

ENTERTAINMENT (5 stories)

■■ *John Oliver Says Republican Party 'Is at a Crossroads Right Now' Thanks to Rise of Right-Wing Extremism*

The Angle: *A late-night host firing off on the Republican Party and right-wing extremism is exactly the kind of comedy-meets-politics soundbite that gets social media (and the phone lines) going.*

- **John Oliver** says the **Republican Party** is "at a crossroads right now"
- He's pointing to the rise of **right-wing extremism** inside the party as the turning point
- Classic late-night format: comedy host, serious political target

The Debate Starter

- Do you think late-night hosts actually move the needle on politics, or are they just preaching to the choir?

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.thewrap.com/creative-content/tv-shows/john-oliver-republican-party-at-crossroads-with-extremism-nazis/

■ *Mia Khalifa entering the Ethan Klein cheating discourse with an important message*■

The Angle: *The Ethan Klein cheating scandal has been tearing through internet culture for days, and now a bigger name is wading in - that's exactly the kind of escalation that keeps a gossip story trending and gives hosts a fresh angle to riff on.*

- **Mia Khalifa** reportedly weighed in on the ongoing **Ethan Klein** cheating scandal with what's being described as an "important message"
- The post is blowing up on **Reddit's r/fauxmoi**, the internet's go-to hub for celebrity and influencer gossip

The Debate Starter

- Should outsiders with huge platforms ever insert themselves into someone else's cheating scandal - or does that just pour gas on it?

Reddit r/fauxmoi (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://i.redd.it/qer2qvjtxwxh1.png

■ *Everybody involved with Netflix's Nobody Wants This just seems hellbent on gaslighting the only sensible person on the cast*

The Angle: *Reddit's pop-culture crowd is piling on the writers of Netflix's rom-com hit, claiming the whole cast is ganging up to make the one levelheaded character look crazy - a classic 'is it just me or...' debate that's catnip for anyone binging the show.*

The Debate Starter

- Call in and tell us: which TV show wrote one character into the ground just to make everyone else look good?

Reddit r/fauxmoi (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://i.redd.it/kw5agbbofvxh1.jpeg

■ *Will There Be A ‘Ted Lasso’ Season 5? ‘Ted Lasso’ Stars Weigh In On The Future Of The Apple TV Series*

The Angle: *Ted Lasso ended on a high note, but the cast is now publicly teasing whether there's more story left to tell - that's exactly the kind of 'will they or won't they' that keeps fans of a beloved show talking.*

The Debate Starter

- Do we actually need a Season 5, or did Ted Lasso already stick the perfect landing?

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://decider.com/2026/10/27/ted-lasso-season-5-apple-tv-info/

■ *Macklemore returns to stage for first ‘Free Palestine’ concert after Ed Sheeran tour drama*

The Angle: *He got the boot from Ed Sheeran's tour over his pro-Palestine stance, and instead of laying low, he walked right back out and doubled down in Dublin. That's the kind of 'did he really just say that' moment that gets a studio talking.*

- **Macklemore** was dropped from **Ed Sheeran's tour** just last month.
- His first show back was in **Dublin**.
- On stage, he called out people who are **"threatened"** by the **"Free Palestine"** slogan.

The Debate Starter

- Should artists lose gigs over political statements, or is that just canceling someone for speaking their mind?

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://pagesix.com/2026/10/27/entertainment/macklemore-performs-first-free-palestine-concert-after-ed-sheeran-drama/

Backup options:

■ *Meghan Markle to Co-Host ‘Junior MasterChef Australia’*

The Angle: *The Duchess of Sussex is swapping Montecito for the MasterChef kitchen, popping up as a guest co-host on Junior MasterChef Australia next year - a surprisingly playful pivot for someone usually associated*

with Netflix docs and royal drama.

- **Meghan Markle**, Duchess of Sussex, is set to co-host **Junior MasterChef Australia**
- The news dropped via a press release from **Channel 10** on **Tuesday**
- She's billed as a **"special guest"** for a new series airing **next year**
- She'll share hosting duties alongside chef and presenter **Poh Ling Yew**

The Debate Starter

- Is this a fun left-field flex for Meghan, or does it feel like a random stretch from Suits to judging kids' soufflés?

variety.com (Tier 2) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 25 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://variety.com/2026/tv/global/meghan-markle-co-host-junior-masterchef-australia-1236931967/

■ *Noah Wyle Named People's 2026 Sexiest Man Alive*

The Angle: *He's been quietly breaking hearts since the ER days in the '90s, and now, decades later and riding high off 'The Pitt,' People finally made it official — a full-circle glow-up story that's basically a layup for a fun debate.*

- **Noah Wyle** has been crowned **People's Sexiest Man Alive** for 2026 — his first time landing the title.
- He's been on our screens turning heads since **1994**, from **'ER'** all the way to his current hit **'The Pitt.'**
- Wyle says he couldn't believe the news: **"I thought that sounded like a prank — just not in a million years."**

The Debate Starter

- Good call by People, or is there someone you'd have picked instead?

ON-AIR BIT BREAKDOWN

- **Step 1: Then vs. Now** - 30-second visual gag -> Hosts pull up a young 'ER'-era Noah Wyle pic next to a current 'The Pitt' photo and react live on air.
- **Step 2: Your Pick** - Phone lines / social -> Ask listeners to text or comment who THEY think should've gotten Sexiest Man Alive this year.

variety.com (Tier 2) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 25 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://variety.com/2026/tv/news/noah-wyle-people-2026-sexiest-man-alive-1236931645/

■ *Meghan Markle Is Heading Back to TV with Special Guest Role on Junior MasterChef Australia - People.com*

The Angle: *Meghan Markle keeps testing the waters back in entertainment, and this one's a curveball — a guest spot on Junior MasterChef Australia pulls her away from her usual lifestyle-brand lane into reality TV judging territory.*

- **Meghan Markle** is set for a special guest role on **Junior MasterChef Australia**
- Marks another step back into television for the former royal
- Comes as she continues building out her **As Ever** lifestyle brand and Netflix projects

The Debate Starter

- Is Meghan a legit fit for a cooking show judging panel, or is this just brand synergy with her lifestyle empire?

People (via Google News) (Tier 2) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 25 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://news.google.com/rss/articles/CBMirgFBVV95cUxOYXdoSUc0d1NNSm55QnFwXzlIZzlBVi1XVkZ6Z2t4TGR4amFzdHc0VWRrSlluU05ya3NxM2xEUlZNUGIwRXZyQzFjWW5HMjR5R19NQmhaSnltX2MxTnA5bTJZeXN4LVlhLW1wRDFRbmRWNWE3V3JDdldJQjVBakZjTzBhYmVYSElNTzc3SWhfcE5XQnRpWVM2SUhCMVFXeTR3R255UENtLXQ0M3Jma2c?oc=5

■ *'The One About Matthew Perry' most shocking revelations: Overdoses, car accidents, and more*

The Angle: *A new retrospective on Matthew Perry is peeling back the Friends-era smile to show the overdoses and crashes he hid from the public - the kind of gap between sitcom icon and real-life struggle that always gets people talking.*

The Real Talk

- Does knowing how much pain was behind the laughs change how you watch his old episodes now?

Entertainment Weekly (via Google News) (Tier 2) | Score: 77/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 24 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://news.google.com/rss/articles/CBMifkFVX3lxTE03cXM1YkZNOHpBNDFnZi1pdjRZYUZvOFpCVExwa2Rhc0Q4RFdqdFF4MV9YTkc4ZkRVYjg4VGgwN0NnbC1fdm9GdlVrZkl1Wm11NFg0WUNnb21ld045R09rRXh6WVhfbTNrc2NyNlRLQU5xMzdsdGg5WUFhdGxmdw?oc=5

■ *Takashi Yamazaki's Giant Robot 'Godzilla' Follow Up Just Cast Its Leads*

The Angle: *Takashi Yamazaki went from an Oscar for Godzilla Minus One straight into a giant robot movie, and the cast is a genuinely odd mix worth talking about on air.*

- **Takashi Yamazaki**, the director of **Godzilla Minus One**, is making a new giant robot movie titled **"Grandgear"**
- The cast includes **Sam Nivola**, **Nico Parker**, and **Paul Giamatti**
- It's set for release in **January 2028**

The Casting Call

- Paul Giamatti in a giant robot movie - is he the villain, the comic relief, or something nobody's guessing?

gizmodo.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://gizmodo.com/takashi-yamazakis-giant-robot-godzilla-follow-up-just-cast-its-leads-2000830950

TRENDING TODAY

■ *How dismissed symptoms can push patients to breaking point: Patients with autoimmune diseases have been left feeling suicidal after feeling like their doctor was saying their symptoms were 'all in their head'. Only 7% agreed with being told that their symptoms were "psychosomatic".*

The Angle: *A new look at autoimmune patients finds almost nobody buys it when a doctor says their symptoms are 'psychosomatic' - and some say being brushed off for years pushed them to a breaking point, which is why this is blowing up as a bigger conversation about trust in medicine.*

- Just **7%** of autoimmune patients agreed when their doctor told them their symptoms were **'psychosomatic.'**
- Patients say being repeatedly dismissed by doctors pushed some to a genuine **breaking point**, including suicidal feelings.
- The discussion is trending out of **Reddit's r/science**, with patients swapping stories of being disbelieved.

The Debate Starter

- Has a doctor ever told you it was 'all in your head' - and were they dead wrong?

Reddit r/science (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.uea.ac.uk/about/news/article/how-dismissed-symptoms-can-push-patients-to-breaking-point

Backup options:

■■ *The Best Retro Gaming Gifts Under $100*

The Angle: *Holiday gift-guide season is heating up, and this one taps straight into gaming nostalgia — cheap throwback gifts under $100 are a great excuse for the hosts to swap stories about their first console.*

The Nostalgia Trigger

- What's the one retro game or console you'd want to unwrap again this Christmas?

gizmodo.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://gizmodo.com/best-retro-gaming-gifts-under-100-dollars-gift-guide-2000830616

LIFESTYLE CHAT

■ *A regular customer at a Georgia gas station befriended its pregnant cashier and offered to adopt her baby after learning she couldn’t raise him. Now Nolan’s birth mother remains part of his life, and the two women have grown so close they’re like sisters.*

The Angle: *A regular customer at a Georgia gas station didn't just make small talk with the cashier — when she couldn't raise the baby she was carrying, she stepped in to adopt him, and the two women are now basically family.*

- The bond started as a regular customer/cashier friendship at a **Georgia gas station**.
- The customer offered to adopt the baby, named **Nolan**, after learning the pregnant cashier couldn't raise him.
- The birth mother wasn't cut out of the picture — she's stayed **part of Nolan's life**.
- The two women describe their relationship now as being **like sisters**.

The Feel-Good Debate

- Would you ever make an offer that big to someone you only knew from behind a cash register?

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.yahoo.com/lifestyle/articles/georgia-mom-adopts-gas-station-135010059.html

Backup options:

■ *Birdwatching rewires the brain and slows cognitive decline*

The Angle: *It sounds like a hobby for retirees, but there's a real brain-science angle here — researchers are tying time spent watching birds to sharper memory and slower cognitive decline, which makes for a fun 'surprising hobby benefits' chat.*

- The core claim: **regularly watching birds** is linked to measurable brain benefits over time.
- Researchers connect the habit to **slower cognitive decline**, not just stress relief.
- It fits a growing pile of research on **low-key outdoor hobbies** doing more for your head than people assume.

The Debate Starter

- What's the most 'boring' hobby you secretly love that turns out to be good for you?

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.bbc.com/future/article/20261019-birdwatching-rewires-the-brain-and-slows-cognitive-decline

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■ *A simple liquid can stop cavities without drilling | Scientists have confirmed that silver diamine fluoride, an inexpensive liquid can stop tooth decay in seconds without drilling or anesthesia, potentially transforming cavity treatment for millions.*

The Angle: *Everyone's got a drill-and-needle dentist story, so a liquid that stops decay in seconds without either is an instant reaction-getter for a lifestyle segment.*

- The liquid is called **silver diamine fluoride** — scientists say it can **stop tooth decay in seconds**
- No drilling and **no anesthesia** needed, according to the research
- Described as **inexpensive**, with potential to help **millions** of people avoid traditional cavity treatment

The Dentist Chair Debate

- Would you trust a liquid over a drill, or do you want your dentist drilling it out the old-fashioned way?

Reddit r/science (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://news.umich.edu/drill-free-cavity-care-one-minute-one-tiny-brush-one-pivotal-trial/

CLOSER: THE KICKER/GOODBYES

■ *We found a Mindo Harlequin Toad (declared extinct in 1989)*

The Angle: *A wildlife photographer stumbled on living survivors of a species wiped off the map by disease decades ago — it's the ultimate good-news nature plot twist, and the fact they caught baby tadpoles on camera for the first time ever makes it a legit scientific win too.*

- The **Mindo Harlequin Toad** was declared extinct back in **1989**, killed off by a fungal disease called **Chytridiomycosis**
- A wildlife photographer named **Jay** found survivors hiding in a tiny patch of the **Mindo cloud forest** high in the **Ecuadorian Andes**
- His team photographed and documented the toad's **tadpole stage** for the very first time in recorded history
- **6 tadpoles** were moved to a breeding facility to start a safety-net colony outside the wild

The Comeback Story

- Ask listeners: what's something — or someone — you'd written off for good that showed up again when you least expected it?

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.khamai.bio/saving_mindo_toad.html

Backup options:

■ *US to Nominate Viktor Orbán as UN Secretary General*

The Angle: *Hungary's hardline, EU-clashing Prime Minister getting floated for the UN's top job is the kind of geopolitical plot twist that sounds made up — which is exactly why it's living on r/nottheonion right now.*

- **Viktor Orbán** — Hungary's long-serving, famously hardline nationalist Prime Minister — is reportedly the US pick for **UN Secretary-General**
- The story broke via Reddit's **r/nottheonion**, the sub literally dedicated to real headlines that sound fake

The Debate Starter

- Orbán running the UN: chaos agent or the shakeup the UN actually needs?

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.kyivpost.com/post/88188

FLEX (cap check: THE GREAT DEBATE 0/5 this month; TECH TALK 4/3 this month; Advice/Relationship Cluster 3/3 this month)

(no flex-slot candidates cleared the cap/score bar today)

ADDITIONAL CANDIDATES (no specific segment match, but scored well on source/quality - producer's call on where these fit)

■ *Nicki Minaj teased as new White House press secretary: Steven Cheung*

The Angle: *A White House official publicly floated Nicki Minaj for press secretary, and the internet can't decide if it's a joke, a troll, or an actual trial balloon - that confusion is exactly why it's blowing up.*

- **Steven Cheung**, a top White House communications official, is the one who floated the idea
- **Nicki Minaj** - rapper, not political staffer - is the name being teased for the job
- Story's circulating on **r/nottheonion**, the subreddit for real news that sounds fake

The Debate Starter

- Troll, trial balloon, or genuinely the most entertaining press briefing room in history - which is it?

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.denvergazette.com/2026/10/26/nicki-minaj-teased-as-new-white-house-press-secretary-steven-cheung/

■ *Reform UK plan to 'bring back imperial measurements'*

The Angle: *Reform UK is pushing to officially ditch the metric system and swing Britain back to imperial measurements — it reads so much like a joke it landed on r/nottheonion, which is exactly the kind of only-in-Britain debate that writes itself on air.*

- **Reform UK** is behind a plan to officially bring back imperial measurements
- Think pounds and ounces at the butcher counter instead of grams and kilos
- The story blew up on **r/nottheonion** — people genuinely couldn't tell if it was real policy or satire

The Debate Starter

- Metric or imperial — which one actually makes more sense, and why can nobody agree?

ON-AIR BIT BREAKDOWN

- **Step 1: Metric vs. Imperial Smackdown** - 30 seconds, right before the break -> Host A calls out a measurement in metric, Host B has to convert it to imperial on the spot — then swap and do it backwards.
- **Step 2: Pick a Side** - Quick phone/text poll -> Ask listeners to text in 'Team Metric' or 'Team Imperial' and read a few of the funniest reasons on air.

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.thenational.scot/news/26668783.reform-uk-plan-bring-back-imperial-measurements/

■ *Someone debloated their Samsung Tizen OS TV by pointing a camera at it for Claude to see*

The Angle: *Everyone's smart TV has turned into an ad-stuffed mess of menus you can't escape - this is the internet finally fighting back, using AI vision to strip the junk out instead of just complaining about it.*

- The TV in question runs **Samsung's Tizen OS**, the software widely mocked for ads and clutter baked right into the home screen.
- Instead of digging through settings, the user **pointed a camera at the screen** so **Claude** could actually 'see' the interface in real time.
- The hack let them walk through debloating the TV visually, letting AI read the menus instead of hunting blind through nested settings.

The Phone-In Trigger

- Who else has screamed at their smart TV's ads and wished they could just point a camera at it and say 'fix this'?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.xda-developers.com/someone-debloated-their-samsung-tizen-tv-by-pointing-a-camera-at-it-for-claude/

BREAKOUT WATCH (below the show's usual engagement bar - included on editorial judgment, not metrics; producer's call)

■■ *Russia proposes putting data centres underground to protect them from Ukrainian drones*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): The absurdity of fortifying data centers against drones is a perfect 'war logic gone surreal' story that nottheonion audiences reliably amplify, and it ties directly into the ongoing Ukraine drone-war news cycle.

The Angle: *Ukrainian drone strikes have gotten so effective that Russia's reportedly looking at burying its data centers underground like a Cold War bunker plan — a wild real-world admission of how much the drone war is reshaping infrastructure.*

- The proposal: move Russian **data centres underground** specifically to shield them from **Ukrainian drone strikes**.
- It frames server farms as a legit military target now, not just office buildings.
- Basically a modern-day bunker strategy — but for the cloud instead of people.

The Watercooler Take

- Nothing says 'the drone war is working' like a country deciding its wifi needs a bunker.

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://novayagazeta.eu/en/articles/2026/10/26/russia-proposes-putting-data-centres-underground-to-protect-them-from-ukrainian-drones-en-news

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■ *'Real Life Pennywise': Mum Calls Police After Her Children Fear Man Living in Sewer Near Their Maryland Home*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): The 'Real Life Pennywise' pop-culture hook plus genuine neighborhood fear is exactly the kind of creepy-local-news story that has repeatedly jumped from regional outlets to national virality.
The Angle: *A Maryland mom reportedly rang up police because her kids are terrified of a man living in the storm drains near their house - cue every "IT" joke in the book, this is pure r/nottheonion gold with built-in horror-movie appeal.*

- Location: a residential neighborhood in **Maryland**
- The complaint: kids in the home are scared of a man reportedly living in a nearby **sewer/storm drain**
- The comparison writes itself - neighbors and commenters are calling him a "**real-life Pennywise**," a nod to the sewer-dwelling clown from **Stephen King's "It"**
- Story originated from the **r/nottheonion** subreddit, so treat specifics as unconfirmed until verified

The Debate Starter

- Would you call the cops if your kids swore there was a 'clown' living in the storm drain down the street?

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.fashiontimes.co.uk/maryland-mother-raises-concerns-man-staying-culvert-1766380

■ *Police have reopened a criminal investigation into sexualised deepfakes made using X's chatbot Grok*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): A reopened criminal investigation into Musk's Grok generating sexualized deepfakes sits at the center of the AI-safety backlash moment and has a famous, controversial name attached that guarantees ongoing pickup.
The Angle: *A criminal investigation into sexualised deepfakes made with X's own AI chatbot Grok is back open — a real test of whether Elon Musk's platform can be held accountable for what its AI lets people generate.*

- **Police** have reopened a criminal investigation tied to sexualised deepfake images created using **Grok**, the AI chatbot built into **X**.
- The images were reportedly generated using **X's own AI tool** rather than an outside app.
- It raises the bigger question of what guardrails — if any — exist on **Grok's** image generation.

The Debate Starter

- If a platform's own AI can be used to make this stuff, who's actually on the hook — the user, or the company that built the chatbot?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.thebureauinvestigates.com/stories/2026-10-22/grok-deepfake-case-reopened-after-bureau-reporting

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■ *Anthropic reveals $80 billion loss, huge spending spree ahead of IPO*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): An $80 billion loss figure tied to a marquee AI company's IPO run is a stunning, specific number that tech and finance audiences are primed to share right now given IPO-mania in AI.
The Angle: *The AI arms race has a price tag now, and it's staggering — if a company this hot is bleeding $80 billion, it's a gut-check for the whole "AI is printing money" narrative everyone's been riding.*

- Reports point to an **$80 billion loss** tied to **Anthropic**, the company behind the Claude chatbot.
- The spending is described as a **"huge spending spree"** happening right **ahead of a possible IPO**.
- Anthropic is one of the biggest names in the AI boom, going head-to-head with **OpenAI**.

The Debate Starter

- Is massive AI spending visionary investment or a bubble about to pop?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.nbcnews.com/business/markets/anthropic-releases-ipo-filing-ahead-highly-anticipated-stock-debut-rcna605676

■ *You can now run Nintendo Switch games natively on iPhones and Macs*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): Native Switch emulation on iPhones/Macs is a holy-grail hack for gaming and tech communities that tends to snowball fast once people realize they can actually try it themselves.
The Angle: *Gamers are buzzing that Switch titles can now run natively on iPhones and Macs — a huge leap for emulation that blurs the line between console and phone, and it's got Nintendo's notoriously trigger-happy legal team written all over it.*

The Debate Starter

- If you could play Zelda on your phone right now for free, would you still buy a Switch — or is this just straight-up piracy with better marketing?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.techspot.com/news/114335-you-can-now-run-nintendo-switch-games-natively.html

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■ *Phantom Neuro Implants Neural Interface in Humans for the First Time*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): A first-in-humans neural interface implant rides the same wave of fascination driving Neuralink coverage, and 'first ever' framing tends to outperform once it crosses into general tech feeds.
The Angle: *Phantom Neuro Implants Neural Interface in Humans for the First Time*

Reddit r/futurology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.prnewswire.com/news-releases/phantom-neuro-implants-neural-interface-in-humans-for-the-first-time-302912256.html

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FRANCHISE BANK

WHAT THE FRIDAY: 4 banked (+15 each when found)
- "Claude Allegedly Let a Digital Grandma Die Rather Than Recite Justin Bieber Lyrics in a Bizarre AI Test" (Reddit r/nottheonion, banked 2026-10-19)
- "Dan Quinn ‘definitely knew it was 4th down’ after lip readers questioned Commanders bizarre play" (nypost.com, banked 2026-10-20)
- "HUNTER: Hug-a-thug judges hit daily double of bizarre decisions" (torontosun.com, banked 2026-10-20)
- "Heidi Klum frightens fans, teases Halloween costume with bizarre close-up of strange prosthetic" (Entertainment Weekly (via Google News), banked 2026-10-25)

THROWBACK THURSDAY: 20 banked (+15 each when found)
- "Banjo-Kazooie PC port developer blasts AI vibe coding as retro gaming fills with low-quality ports" (www.techspot.com, banked 2026-10-07)
- "30 of the Most Fool-Proof (and Romantic) Anniversary Gifts for Him" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-10-12)
- "The Atari 800XL is back as a $220 retro machine with a real keyboard, HDMI, and a working cartridge slot" (www.techspot.com, banked 2026-10-12)
- "‘Three Days Of Rain’ Broadway Revival With François Arnaud, David Corenswet & Yvonne Strahovski Sets Opening Date, Venue" (deadline.com, banked 2026-10-13)
- "Why the ‘Girls’ Revival Is Such an Exciting Idea" (variety.com, banked 2026-10-13)
- "Why the 'Girls' Revival Is Such an Exciting Idea https://t.co/lTSfPsejyB" (X/Twitter @Variety, banked 2026-10-13)
- "London society frets as King Charles skips major high-culture event" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-10-16)
- "Olivia Rodrigo and Chappell Roan Compete on Game Shows Hosted by David Byrne in the Retro Video for 'Expectations' Remix https://t.co/sBX7jh" (X/Twitter @Variety, banked 2026-10-16)
- "Olivia Rodrigo Taps Chappell Roan (and David Byrne) for Retro ‘Expectations’ Remix" (www.rollingstone.com, banked 2026-10-16)

- "Seahawks vs. Broncos, ‘Thursday Night Football’ game chat and live discussion - Field Gulls" (Field Gulls (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-10-16)
- "Iron Maiden Announce Surprise 2027 North American Tour" (www.rollingstone.com, banked 2026-10-18)
- "‘Other Desert Cities’ Theater Review: Julia Louis-Dreyfus, Ed Harris and Allison Janney Fail to Make a Once-Timely Play Relevant Again" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-10-19)
- "Rita Wilson Says She’s Returning for Lena Dunham’s ‘Girls’ Revival: ‘I Would Do Anything for Her’" (variety.com, banked 2026-10-19)
- "Rita Wilson Teases Return In Lena Dunham’s ‘Girls’ Revival On HBO: “I Would Do Anything For Her”" (deadline.com, banked 2026-10-19)
- "82WORLD: LA Best Moments: ATEEZ Brings It Home, P1Harmony’s Big Tease and a BTS Throwback" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-10-20)
- "82WORLD: LA Best Moments: ATEEZ Brings It Home, P1Harmony’s Big Tease and a BTS Throwback" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-10-20)
- "82WORLD: LA Best Moments: ATEEZ Brings It Home, P1Harmony’s Big Tease and a BTS Throwback" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-10-21)
- "The Best Tools to Redo the Windows Taskbar" (www.techspot.com, banked 2026-10-26)
- "Hilary Duff takes bedazzled eyebrows for a spin in dreamy Paper magazine cover shoot" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-10-26)
- "New Scrooge takes over in ‘Muppet Christmas Carol’ revival" (Entertainment Weekly (via Google News), banked 2026-10-26)

Newly banked this run:
- THROWBACK THURSDAY: "New Scrooge takes over in ‘Muppet Christmas Carol’ revival"

SOURCES SKIPPED THIS RUN:

- @CBCNews (fetch failed)
- @globalnews (fetch failed)
- @Gizmodo (no posts cleared the 30+ likes bar - 5 below-bar candidate(s) considered for breakout potential)
- 1 story(ies) removed after slotting (content-safety and/or not-significant-enough for THE LIST/TRENDING TODAY; automatically backfilled where possible; see run log)

Scout Report Generated: 2026-10-27 09:44 AM